



Odd and even traffic

Delhi introduced regulation that would allow vehicles to ply on alternate days only based on their number plate <http://dgit.in/DelhiOddEven>



Go to Machu Picchu!

Google Street view added Machu Picchu to the places available <http://dgit.in/MachuPicchuGSV>

Cheap Graphics Cards

Agent001 wonders about the economy market

Agent 001

agent001@digit.in

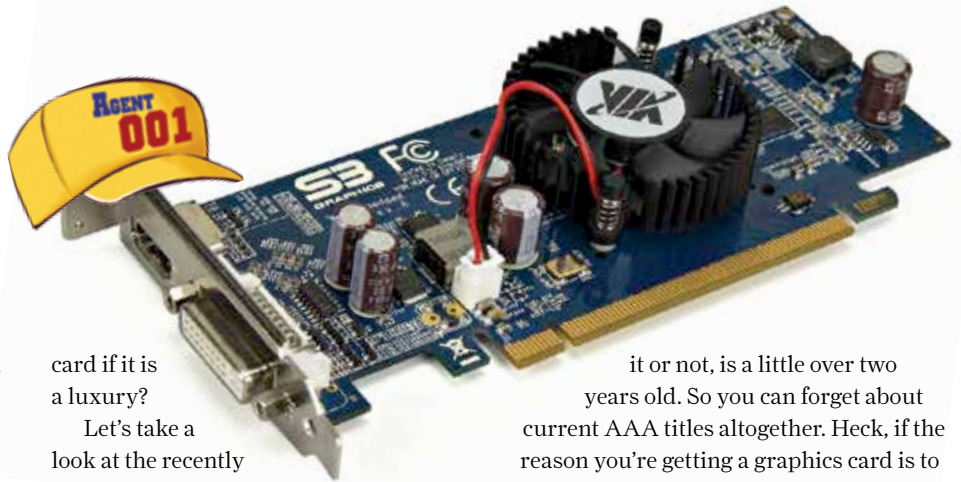
Every now and then, we get a query about which graphics card is the best to get for about ₹5,000. Very few things make me cringe more than such a query and I'd like to explain why. Graphics cards are like every other hardware segment out there. They can be broadly classified into three different price categories – Entry, Mid-range and Enthusiast. And like everything under the sun, the mid-range segment sees the most sales, unless, you happen to be in a price conscious market like India. Here, it's the cheapest cards that sell the most. The case is such that graphics manufacturers expend quite a lot of resources for R&D with countries like India in mind. While graphics cards are like most hardware categories, there's

card if it is a luxury?

Let's take a look at the recently announced NVIDIA GeForce GT 930, the latest in the 900-series aimed at this very low-cost market. There are three variants of the card, each based off three different architectures – Maxwell, Kepler and Fermi. Yes, Fermi. The five-year old GPU architecture. Needless to say, the Maxwell variant is slightly pricey coming in at \$90(₹5,966) and the other two are likely to be priced at \$80(₹5,303) and \$60(₹3,977). The Maxwell GT 930 will have 384 CUDA cores and pack 4 GB of frame buffer capacity at a TDP of just 15W. These cards aren't meant for gaming, or else they'd have carried the GTX moniker and not the GT. They'll run HD movies easily and likely support multiple displays since they do have

it or not, is a little over two years old. So you can forget about current AAA titles altogether. Heck, if the reason you're getting a graphics card is to play Full HD movies on your TV, a credit card sized computer like the Raspberry Pi will do a much better job and give you a more wholesome movie watching experience as well. And if you're willing to wait till February then you could also get the Pine A64+ which does everything that the Raspberry Pi does and more – it easily plays 4K video.

If you were to build an affordable gaming machine with an AMD APU, say an A10-7870K(₹11,960), then your machine will be able crunch out the same performance using just the IGP which is a Radeon R7 having 512 stream processors. So basically, you're getting nothing in return for spending ₹5,966 on a new budget graphics card having the latest Maxwell architecture. This is why we often advise our readers to wait for a while and double up their budget to get something better like the R7 370(₹14,090) or the GTX 950(₹13,400). These cards are way better of an investment and will allow you to play current gen titles running at FullHD with most of the eye candy cranked all the way up. And with each generation of CPUs improving their graphics capabilities, the practice of buying really cheap graphics cards seems even more ridiculous by the day. APAC accounts for the most sales when it comes to the GT series and in a few years, this little market is going to dry up and get cannibalised by the GTX series. 



Get an RPi or a Pine A64+ for HTPCs

one thing that sets them apart from the rest. Having one is most of a luxury and isn't necessary to play games. There exist processor and motherboard combinations which can't drive a display on their own, but this happens to be with the enthusiast or the enterprise segment which is small compared to the rest. So is it really worth buying a ridiculously cheap graphics

the 4 GB VRAM. But when it comes to gaming, they aren't great. If you were to play Battlefield 4 with a GTX 750 which costs just a fraction more, then you'll manage 32-35 FPS on Ultra settings at Full HD. The GT 930 will probably push 22-24 FPS and you might have to crank the settings down a little to get an even 30 FPS throughout. And Battlefield 4, believe